

	TITLE: Acceptable Use Policy	
	DATE CREATED: 10/03/2016	VERSION NUMBER: 5
	DATE OF LAST REVIEW: 06/03/2022	DEPARTMENT OWNER: Information Security

Printed copies are for reference only. Please refer to the electronic copy for the latest version.

1. Purpose

To establish the baseline tenets of what constitutes acceptable use and behavior as it pertains to Premier, Inc.'s data and information resources and assets.

2. Scope

Applies to all workforce members of Premier, Inc. ("Premier") and controlled subsidiary companies.

3. Definitions

Protected Data – Documents, records and electronic data processed, stored or maintained by Premier that may be accessed, used and disclosed by Workforce Members of the Premier organization and third parties as authorized by applicable law, but not to the public. Protected Data includes the following four subsets: Premier Information, Personal Information, Sensitive Personal Information, and Protected Health Information. (For more information, please reference the Premier Data Stewardship Program (DSP) – Part I General Program Policies.)

Temporary Workforce Member – Any contractor, consultant or temporary employee, in a Premier Office or remote, who is not a full-time Premier employee and whose work is under the direct supervision of Premier management. For example, an individual brought in to perform programming activities to supplement our existing programming staff falls under this category, as would a remote individual performing specific tasks assigned and managed by a Premier supervisor. Examples excluded from this category are an outsourced internal auditor working under the direct supervision of the auditing firm's management or an individual working for an outside firm where the firm has been contracted to perform programming activities for Premier and the individual is supervised by the outside firm's management.

Worker – All workforce members and temporary workforce members.

Workforce Member – Any individual employee with logical and/or physical access to Premier information assets and resources.

4. Attachments/References

Data Media Re-use and Disposal Standard
Instant Messaging Policy
Mobile Device Security and Data Management Policy
Premier Data Stewardship Program – Part I General Program Policies
Premier Data Stewardship Program – Part II Administrative Policies
Security and Privacy Violations and Sanctions Policy and Procedure
Social Media Policy

Printed copies are for reference only. Please refer to the electronic copy for the latest version.

POLICY

1. Premier computer resources and access to information assets are provided to users for business use. Use of Premier computing resources for personal purposes is permissible so long as the incremental cost of the usage is negligible, and no business activity is preempted by the personal use. Use of personal email (e.g., Gmail) is not permitted on any Premier asset.
2. To protect the network and its resources, workers are prohibited from connecting any devices to the Premier internal network without the express written permission of IT Infrastructure and Information Security. Please refer to **Appendix A** for examples of prohibited technologies.
3. Workers requiring access to network resources are limited to the minimum necessary resources required to perform their duties, as achievable with existing technology, whether they are using Premier or non-Premier assets.
4. Workers must strictly adhere to all software licensing agreements, copyrights, trademarks, patents and all other state, federal and international laws governing intellectual property and online activities.
5. Workers must contact Legal and/or ITS Business Operations prior to downloading any software.
6. When a Temporary Workforce Member requires access to work with Protected Data on Premier's network, either in a Premier office or remotely, he or she must be provided with a Premier managed computer or virtual desktop to perform the work. All exceptions require prior approval by the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) or designee.
7. The actual last day of the contract is entered in all Temporary Workforce Member onboarding tickets. The manager receives notifications 45, 30 and 15 days in advance before the Temporary Workforce Member's access is automatically removed.
8. All temporary workforce members or persons accessing Premier's internal network with a non-Premier asset must be set up by default with a Premier virtual desktop. If this is not technically feasible, as in the case of various developers and the tools they will use, justification must be made by the requesting manager. All exceptions must be approved by the CISO or designee.

Unacceptable Uses and Activities

9. Workers are prohibited from the following:
 - 9.1 Using computing resources for fraudulent solicitation, any outside business employment or activity, or any activity that could embarrass or open Premier to the possibility of litigation.
 - 9.2 Accessing Premier data/information that is not required for their job function.
 - 9.3 Accessing, storing or distributing material that is obscene, pornographic, threatening, racially or sexually harassing, offensive or disruptive to the working environment, or in violation of any trademark or copyright laws or regulations.
 - 9.4 Using computing resources to perform illegal acts including, but not limited to, transmitting Protected Health Information (PHI) without adequate protection or business need, attempting to gain or gaining access to any computing resource for which explicit authorization has not been given, and storing or transporting pirated software, stolen credit card numbers or passwords.
 - 9.5 Using computing resources to perform malicious acts including, but not limited to, "hacking" into computer resources, monitoring communications, reading another worker's email (without prior permission from a Human Resources authorized representative), and unauthorized monitoring of network traffic or masquerading as another worker.

Printed copies are for reference only. Please refer to the electronic copy for the latest version.

- 9.6 Sharing passwords, keys, and/or other credential information or accessing resources that are not part of their job function even if they have access.
 - 9.7 Making any modifications to Premier assets that result in bypassing or disabling existing security controls without the express written permission of Information Security.
 - 9.7.1 *For the specific case of mandatory encryption software:* The intentional unauthorized disablement of device encryption software on any Premier device or asset is prohibited. This violation will result in termination of the offending individual. If a worker has any reason to believe he or she needs to disable encryption software on any Premier device or asset, the worker must contact Information Security with the request.
 - 9.8 Loading unsupported software or files for personal use which would compromise Premier's information systems in any way.
 - 9.9 Creating, transmitting, sharing, posting, storing or backing up any Protected Data on any unapproved Internet, social media, commercial online systems or cloud-based locations. Please refer to **Appendix A** for examples of prohibited technologies.
 - 9.10 Sending any Protected Data via any non-Premier email account, and the forwarding of Premier email or calendar entries containing Protected Data to any non-Premier email accounts or servers.
 - 9.11 Posting any code to online public forums or repositories such as GitHub or Stack Overflow.
 - 9.12 Accessing personal email from a Premier asset.
10. Access to an online resource does not constitute approval. Approval to use external resources with any Protected Data must be reviewed and approved by the CISO and the Chief Privacy Officer. Requests may be made through the Premier Impact Assessment (PIA) process. PIA requests are made via Premier Now.
11. Approved material that is posted externally must obtain all proper copyright and trademark notices.

Transmission of Protected Data and Monitoring

- 12. When sending Premier Confidential, Regulated or other sensitive information (as defined by the Premier Data Stewardship Program – Part I General Program Policies) including email, files or other data transmission to parties external to Premier, workers must use an approved secure file transfer solution. This includes, but is not limited to, secure email and secure large file transfer. In the case of PHI, the use of Premier's secure email or secure large file transfer solution is mandatory.
- 13. Workers must be professional and appropriate when drafting emails and other forms of communication or documents that will be transmitted via Premier's resource. Workers must use good judgment and take responsibility for correspondence drafted on Premier resources to ensure that it reflects Premier's values of integrity, a passion for performance, innovation and focus on people.
- 14. Premier provides workers with a variety of technologies, including the telephone system, voicemail and computers as well as managed devices like tablets and computers. Issued systems are the property of Premier and must be used primarily for business purposes only. Personal devices are subject to the *Mobile Device Security and Data Management Policy*.
- 15. For security and maintenance, Premier uses security and logging applications to monitor, maintain and protect Premier-provided assets through various methods, including but not limited to:
 - 15.1 Content filtering to Internet sites.
 - 15.2 Access restrictions to run certain applications.
 - 15.3 Remote control of computers and remote user sessions.
 - 15.4 Applications and services to track access and activity both on the Premier internal network and the Internet.

Printed copies are for reference only. Please refer to the electronic copy for the latest version.

16. Workers must not have any expectation of privacy while using Premier-provided assets or technologies. Premier reserves the right to access, review and disclose contents of such assets and technologies to authorized personnel for any business purpose at any time it deems it necessary or appropriate. Examples of business purposes include but are not limited to the following:
- 16.1 Managing use of computer systems including finding lost messages.
 - 16.2 Managing situations in which an individual left the employment of Premier.
 - 16.3 Complying with a subpoena, legal document requirement or investigation into suspected criminal acts.
 - 16.4 Recovering from system failures or other emergencies.
 - 16.5 Investigating suspected breaches of security or privacy, or violations of company policies.
17. By accessing Premier networks, you consent to all activity being monitored. Premier may monitor or intercept electronic mail or transmissions, internet access, keystrokes, Microsoft Teams activity and/or data content in certain circumstances. Use of a computer, VPN or VDI may be subject to monitoring at any and all times, and by any lawful means.

Enforcement

18. Violations of this policy may result in sanctions, disciplinary or legal actions as described in the *Security and Privacy Violations and Sanctions Policy and Procedure*.

Where to Go with Questions and Concerns

Contact the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) with questions or concerns about this Policy.

Appendix A: Examples of Prohibited Technologies Requiring Approval for Use

Type	Examples
Collaboration Tools	Slack, Yammer
Email	Google, Yahoo
File Sharing	DropBox, Box
Online Repositories	GitHub, Stack Overflow
File Backup	Carbonite
Cloud Computing Resources	Amazon Web Services, Google Cloud Engine, Microsoft Azure
Computing Devices	Raspberry Pi, Arduino, Non-Premier Computers
Computer Hardware	Printers, Routers